

Minimalist Ideas: 100 Things You Can Do Today to Live Simpler. « Far Beyond The Stars



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When people think about minimalism, some of them think that it's really hard and it involves throwing out all of their stuff and being a freegan or something. It doesn't. Minimalism is about small steps toward a simple goal. It's totally achievable, but the idea of running around with just a backpack

is really terrifying for folks who have a house full of stuff and a packed schedule.

You're not going to be a minimalist overnight, but by taking tiny steps you're getting there slowly, and more important, simply.

If you can do one of the things on this list today, you'll be a little more minimalist, and that helps! Yes, they're small, but that's fine. Maybe try doing one of these once a day for a hundred days? Maybe some of them will stick, and then you're doing 100 things that make you more of a minimalist. That'd be pretty cool, and I think you can do it!

Here is 100 things you can do today to simplify your life and become more of a minimalist.

- 1, Recycle, donate, throw away one item.
- 2, Eat one less mouthful.
- 3, Spend one less dollar.
- 4, Drive one less mile.
- 5, Watch one less movie.
- 6, Count how many things you own (I own 79 things.)
- 7, Drink one less cup of coffee.
- 8, Cook one meal at home.
- 9, Think one freeing thought.
- 10, Walk to the store once.
- 11, Work one less hour.
- 12, Spend a half an hour meditating.
- 13, Skip dessert.

- 14, Skip the soda.
- 15, Drink one glass of pure water.
- 16, Cook with carrots.
- 17, Cook with kale.
- 18, Give one less gift, give a hug instead.
- 19, Bike to work for one day a week.
- 20, Walk around the block instead of anything.
- 21, Plant one plant that you can someday eat.
- 22, Write one list about how you could be more minimalist.
- 23, Read Tammy's RowdyKittens.
- 25, Read Leo's Mnmlist.
- 26, Read Dave's Minimalist Path.
- 27, Donate one book after you read it.
- 28, Email one story about minimalism to your best friend.
- 29, Write one minimalist thing somewhere prominent in your house.
- 30, Read Walden by Thoreau.
- 31, Create one piece of art with one tool.
- 32, Do one thing at work that you've been meaning to do, but have done fifty things instead.
- 33, Take a plane trip somewhere with only a backpack.
- 34, Unfriend one friend on Facebook.
- 35, Unfollow one person on Twitter.
- 36, Follow me on Twitter.
- 37, Cook without meat for one meal.
- 38, Sit in front of a fire for an hour.
- 39, Sit under a tree for an hour.
- 40, Watch birds for an hour.
- 41, Dedicate one hour to reading a book.
- 42, Unplug your TV for one evening.
- 43, Write one paragraph on how you could become more minimalist.
- 44, Donate/recycle/trash one memento that you've cherished since high school.
- 45, Tell one person you love them.
- 46, Take the train to work once.
- 47, Take one yoga class.
- 48, Give some of your money to a charity that helps starving children.
- 49, Quit your job that you hate (don't worry, you'll be okay.)
- 50, Write one blog post on minimalism.
- 51, Tweet once about minimalism.
- 52, Dream one dream that you could never do if you had a house full of stuff.
- 53, Redefine your idea of success as being freer.
- 54, Work from home for one day.
- 55, Turn off the lights for one day.
- 56, Walk on a beach with a friend, once.

- 57, Make your own coffee in the morning, once.
- 58, Make one payment to get yourself closer to being out of debt.
- 59, Walk down Broadway between Houston and Canal in Manhattan and don't buy anything.
- 60, Walk down Hawthorne in Portland without buying anything.
- 61, Read a book in a bookstore without buying it.
- 62, Take your lunch to work for one day.
- 63, Cancel your cable TV.
- 64, Cancel your Netflix.
- 65, Delete your Facebook.
- 66, Turn off your phone for one day, call everyone back the next day.
- 67, Don't drink one more beer.
- 68, Do one action without doing any other action.
- 69, Watch a butterfly.
- 70, Watch a fruit fly.
- 71, Clean your counter top so the fruit fly goes away.
- 72, Clear your desk.
- 73, Take everything out of your car.
- 74, Decide what you'd take with you if you left today.
- 75, Realize that you can't take it all with you when you die.
- 76, Think about what people will remember you for when you're gone.
- 77, Send one short email that conveys just as much information as a long email.
- 78, Have one friend over to dinner.
- 79, Spend one day with your dog.
- 80, [Subscribe to this RSS feed.](#)
- 81, Buy one (necessary) thing with that jar of change that everyone has.
- 82, MP3 and sell/donate/recycle/trash one CD.
- 83, Stay home for one friday/saturday evening.
- 84, Take a photo of a tree.
- 85, Buy one less boxed thing at the grocery store.
- 86, Avoid buying in bulk once.
- 87, Breathe slower and more steadily.
- 88, Close your eyes for ten minutes.
- 89, Smile at someone you don't know.
- 90, Walk slower.
- 91, Say thank you, smile, and look into the eyes of someone you don't know.
- 92, Sit on a park bench.
- 93, Lie on a beach (with sunscreen on.)
- 94, Leave your house without a backpack.
- 95, Leave your house without your cellphone.
- 96, Sell/donate/recycle/trash one object you haven't used in a month.
- 97, Sell/donate/recycle/trash one object that you haven't used in a year.

98, Think one thought for 15 minutes.

99, Do one yoga pose.

100, Text your girlfriend/boyfriend/someone and tell them that you love them.

Whew, that was a lot of thinking for one morning.

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If you like one of these ideas, share them with one person.

I probably left some out, can you think of one thing that you do to be a minimalist? Leave it in the comments.

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